

Sabor sang Panahon

Overview

The game is set in present-day Iloilo. The player wakes up hungry in their apartment and searches for food. While checking the room, they find an old damaged newspaper about an unknown dish from La Paz.

The article is incomplete. Only fragments are readable:

broth
noodles
market
oldtimer
La Paz
Iloilo

The player does not recognize the dish, but it feels strangely familiar. They activate their AI assistant:

AMBot: Artificial Mapping Bot

“Document scan incomplete.”

“Dish identity unknown.”

“Recommended route: apartment to La Paz.”

The player finds a jeepney route map and uses the jeepney only to travel from the apartment to La Paz.

Arrival In La Paz

Once the player reaches La Paz, travel becomes fully on foot. They walk through streets, alleys, market areas, and familiar neighborhood spaces.

The first person they visit is their grandmother in their old house.

She is sick and preparing to leave later that afternoon to buy medicine. She says she will return around dinner. The player asks her about the dish in the newspaper, but she cannot fully remember its name.

She gives gentle hints:

“May sabaw to... mainit-init.”

“Daw may noodles.”

“Sa La Paz gid na ginapangita sang una.”

“Ang baho sang sabaw ya, makapadumdum gid.”

Before she leaves, she tells the player there may still be old things around the house and neighborhood that could help them remember.

The player feels bad seeing her sick and tired. They decide:

Find the lost dish and cook it for Grandma before dinner.

Ingredient Hunt

The player explores La Paz on foot. AMBot helps by mapping clue zones, analyzing NPC dialogue, and predicting where ingredients might be found.

The player searches for:

- miki noodles
- pork broth base
- pork liver or meat
- chicharon
- garlic
- scallions
- egg

AMBot uses real AI/procedural logic to decide where clues and ingredients appear from valid handcrafted locations.

Example AMBot lines:

“NPC testimony detected: market vendor.”

“Mapping possible ingredient zone.”

“Probability high: noodles near market stalls.”

“Cultural Echo detected nearby.”

The player follows **Cultural Echoes** instead of direct markers. As they approach ingredients, the sounds grow clearer:

- boiling broth
- bowls clinking
- chopping garlic
- jeepney horns in the distance
- market chatter
- faint Hiligaynon voices

AMBot Runs Out

After the player finds all ingredients, AMBot analyzes the clues and reveals that the dish is almost complete. But the final artifact is still missing.

“Ingredient profile complete.”
“Required heritage artifact: Memory Bowl.”
“Searching local records...”
“Token limit reached.”
“AMBot cannot continue reconstruction.”
“Manual search required.”

Now the AI can no longer guide the player. The final step must be done by human memory, observation, and instinct.

The player returns to the old house and searches without AMBot’s help.

The Covered Sign

While searching the house, the player notices a large object covered in cloth. It may have been visible earlier, but easy to ignore.

They remove the cloth.

The sign reads:

Ted’s Oldtimer La Paz Batchoy

Or the safer fictional version:

Tiyo Tedio’s Oldtimer Batchoyan

This reveals the truth: the old house was once a batchoyan connected to La Paz’s food memory.

At that moment, Cultural Echoes intensify:

- people ordering
- bowls clinking
- broth boiling
- footsteps on wooden floors
- jeepneys passing outside
- someone says:

“Isa ka batchoy, mainit-init pa.”

The Urgency

Grandma will return at dinner, so the player has limited time. The timer begins after Grandma leaves.

The goal is not just to solve a mystery. It is personal:

Cook the forgotten dish before Grandma comes home.

If the player fails to find the Memory Bowl and complete the dish before time runs out, the game returns to the start of the final search phase. The player tries again from the moment they begin searching for the bowl.

The Memory Bowl

The player follows the echoes through the house. They search shelves, drawers, the kitchen, the old counter, and hidden corners until they find the final artifact:

The Memory Bowl

The custom discovery screen appears immediately:

Artifact Discovered: The Memory Bowl

Dish Identity Restored: La Paz Batchoy

“Submitting artifact to Official Game Portal...”

The game calls the official Game Portal API. The permanent digital gallery is handled by the official portal, not by your game.

Batchoy: Dumduman sang La Paz

Grandma returns home for dinner. The player serves her the dish.

She tastes it, pauses, and finally remembers.

“Batchoy...”

“Amo ni. Amo gid ni ang sabor sang La Paz.”

The house briefly shifts into memory: customers eating, steam rising, people laughing, bowls clinking, the old batchoyan alive again.

Failure State

If the timer runs out before the player finds the Memory Bowl and cooks the dish:

Grandma returns home before dinner is ready. The player realizes they were close but did not finish in time.

The game restarts at the final search phase:

Try again: Find the Memory Bowl before Grandma returns.

This keeps the pressure without forcing the player to replay the whole game.

Core Timeline

hunger → newspaper → jeepney to La Paz → grandmother’s hints → grandma leaves for medicine → ingredient hunt on foot → AMBot runs out of tokens → timed Memory Bowl search

→ sign reveal → artifact discovery → Game Portal API → cook Batchoy → grandma remembers.